Find, evaluate, and select digital data sources

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Any questions from the lecture?

Notes

- **Milestone 1** – Friday, 25th of April, 23:59, via email to TA (xbk406@sodas.ku.dk)
- Feedback – next seminar
- Submission should contain:
  1. Description and justification of research topic and question
  2. Description and justification for central datasite(s)
- Remember to book your supervision slot for Thursday – seminar hours are held as usual.
- Starting next week – **one slide update** every Tuesday.

Scouting and evaluating datasites

It's important to know what to look for when scouting and choosing a datasite.

When selecting a datasite, you need to check if it is realistic to use the datasite, and ways to do this are presented by both Kozinets and Venturini.

Investigation process for datasite (Kozinets, 2020, p.215)

1. **Simplification**: Translate the research question into keywords/search terms
2. **Searching**: Use search terms, hashtags, and trends to find potential datasites
3. **Scouting**: Observe and filter sites to narrow down choices
4. **Selecting**: Apply evaluation criteria to choose datasites
5. **Saving**: Capture and store relevant data (screenshots, print/save, copy/paste, scraping)

Quality Criteria for the datasites (Kozinets, 2020, pp.227-229)

- **Relevance:** Connection to research question (beyond just keywords)
- **Activity:** Recency and regularity of information/updates
- **Interactivity**: Two-or-more-way communication between participants
- **Diversity:** Expression of different perspectives (not single-voice dominated)
- **Richness:** Presence of detail, description, emotion and interconnection ("deep data")

Reality Checklist (Venturini et al., 2018)

- ✓ Consider the platform's role in your study object - *How much of your object of study occurs in the medium that you are studying?*
- ✓ Balance theoretical relevance with source-specific practices
- ✓ Account for data access limitations (APIs, webpages, sampling)
- ✓ Understand how data is "given" by the medium

Kozinets, R. V. (2020). *Netnography: The Essential Guide to Qualitative Social Media Research* (3rd ed.). SAGE Publications.
Venturini, T., Bounegru, L., Gray, J., & Rogers, R. (2018). A reality check(list) for digital methods. *New Media & Society, 20*(11), 4195-4217. https://doi.org/10.1177/1461444818769236

Ethical considerations and immersing

Always think of how you collect data and the ethical considerations.

Four immersive operations

(Kozinets, 2020, p.284-297)

1. **Reconnoitering:** Making reconnaissance of your data landscape
   - Providing picture of data landscape/mapping
   - Using "telescope and microscope" approaches (zooming in and out)
2. **Recording:** Documenting your data collection journey
   - Not just downloading data but documenting interpretations and reactions
3. **Researching**: Making sense of the data
   - Creating conceptual notes connecting observations to theory
   - Abstracting from concrete cases to theorize and formulate hypotheses
4. **Reflecting:** Documenting your reactions and perspective
   - Challenge your bias, habituated thinking, and affective reactions

Ethical considerations in selection

(Kozinets, 2020, pp.163-187)

- **Key Principles**: Autonomy, Beneficence, Non-maleficence, Confidentiality, Integrity
- **Site Classification**: Determine if sites are public or private
- **Risk Assessment**: Sensitive topics and vulnerable populations
- **Data Treatment:** Uncloaked, cloaked, or highly cloaked data
- **Ethics Flowchart**: Decision tree for ethical research procedures

Kozinets, R. V. (2020). *Netnography: The Essential Guide to Qualitative Social Media Research* (3rd ed.). SAGE Publications.

Agenda

1. Evaluate data site

- First, evaluate the current data sites you are considering, using Kozinets's criterias: **relevance, activity, interactivity, diversity, and richness**.

2. Evaluate data traces

- Evaluate the **quality** of each central data trace on your data site – evaluate each of these both in relation to its **type** (i.e., textual, numerical, visual, etc.) and in relation to your **RQ**.

45 min

3. Describe the data generation process

- Describe how your data site **works**. How do you produce content? How do you consume content? How do you interact? How does one become a member?
- Describe **who** is on your data site. Who is active? Who can become active? Who controls the forum? Who owns your data site?

4. Data site selection

- Based on the steps above, **choose** your primary and secondary (if any) data sites.

45 min

5. Revisit your RQ

- Based on your work above, revisit your RQ. Are there any **adjustments** you need to make, different theoretical lenses to consider?

6. Work on your milestone

45 min

Immersion journal examples

Immersion Journal for Twitter & Incels.IS					
Type of observation	Date & Time of obs.	Actual observation	Reflections & discussion	Link to research setting	Index (themes)
Twitter IncelsCo	01/05/2023	incelsCo as the first page. the bio reads "http://Incels.is is a		rch?q=twitter+incels&rlz=1C	Incel community
community Incel Talk	02/05/2023	incels and those that can relate to the situation can talk freely.		ties/1577753486741147662	Incel community
by IncelCo	01/05/2023	having more sex than ever due to sex apps. "It is true, though.	discussion between the	tatus/1653104018632105 99	Physical looks
by IncelCo	01/05/2023	obsession has to stop: "I blame women for the obsession with	matters highly for women,	tatus/1652828338757554 18	physical looks
IncelCo	03/05-2023	axis shows looks-score, while Y axis shows personality score.	having good looks (the	tatus/1653605967479578 62	impacting
by IncelCo	03/05-2023	how men comments on a video. Here the user says that 90%	a deeper discussion of how	tatus/1653878041418821 63	standards
IncelCo	04/05-2023	quote, stating overall that the girl has not yet found a boyfriend	the twitter-forum for a	tatus/1653908149479301 12	body count
IncelCo	05/05-2023			tatus/1654283386997940 22	conservatives,
IncelsCo	06/05-2023	your face."	no gym for your face,	tatus/1654893609353707 52	physical looks
IncelsCo	06/05-2023	men - *"Women handle rejection very poorly, compared to*	handling rejection compared	tatus/1654919153906597 89	dating, rejection,
Fenwick	16/05/2023	like". the post continues by comparing pictures of men and	that women are more	wick/status/1655813781115	looksmatched
community by	16/05/2023	dont care what people think. The blackpill is 100% true. Look at	experience from a male	e995/status/1657877116111	physichal
IncelsCo	16/05/2023	areas are not good if you don't have money to buy a car and	needed for the good life, to	harm/status/1657482225175	appearance,
Twitter post IncelsCo	16/05/2023	say that they have been in a relationship with a short man.	Importance of physical looks	tatus/1656952314622619 65	physical
IncelsCo	16/05/2023	them talk about rizzcession.	you need to do to be a	e/status/1656010048751927	change of
IncelsCo	16/05/2023	If you have to play the game, you've already lost. + picture depicting a crying "self-improver", making fun of how he	/ hierarchy being static,	tatus/1656178332868771 84	powerdynamics,
IncelsCo	16/05/2023	bored and leave you. --> reply to --> 99% of men are fucked.	are never going to be able to	h___/status/1655314237160	unreal
IncelsCo	17/05/2023	resources is not something that I'd ever be interested in doing.	talking about why incels not	tatus/1657071432235450 37	being used for
IncelsCo	17/05/2023		about incel's discussion of	tatus/1656952975019986 94	women, men's
retweetet interstella	17/05/2023	woman nowadays?Modern women can provide for	usefulness - improvement is	4L/status/164085243464479	men, modern
IncelsCo	17/05/2023	body to only have a *chance* of getting a women.	nothing is stopping men	tatus/1655667374882709 50	appearance,
from Incelphobes	17/05/2023	doctrinated into being mean to men who look bad based on	have a better life, be	cLs/status/164018827504 53	disadvantaged by
Their L's Online	17/05/2023	you ask (general consensus among some Incel communities is	from the forum. Saying that	cLs/status/163760101552 33	Truecel
IncelsCo	17/05/2023	average as acceptable.	an example of gender	tatus/1655070834292056 06	attractiveness,
interstellar 5555	17/05/2023	work to cooked food,cleaned house and properly raised	liberation and women's	4L/status/165631350656253	sexual liberation,
interstellar 5555	17/05/2023		this post. Justification of		rape?, women
interstellar 5555	17/05/2023		is eternal, there is no point in	4L/status/165382584187526	Hopelessness,
interstellar 5555	17/05/2023	for men is conditional and contingent upon satisfying her	women --> but why do they	4L/status/165314147477345	Hypergamy
interstellar 5555	17/05/2023	loved conditionally as well. If Chad goes bald or gets into an	women --> but why do they	4L/status/165314147986962	Hypergamy
interstellar 555	17/05/2023	Society: "Sorry you're feeling this way, It's ok to feel down, do	are not supposed to be		Weak men
interstellar 5555	21/05/2023	are told they have to jump thru rings of fire,cure cancer and		4L/status/165997173870322	standards, female
5555	21/05/2023	they are while men are told they have to jump thru rings of	society compared to	4L/status/165997173870322	critique of society
5555	21/05/2023	wanting their looksmatch vs women wanting a 7ft-7figure Chad	that are in their own league	4L/status/165997174282193	empowerment,

Immersion journal examples

Reddit							
ID	Type of observation	Date of observation	Actual observation	Description of observation	Reflection & disscussion	URL	Index (Themes)
1	Subreddit/sextortion	05/05/2024	It happened to me! Via bumble which then moved to all my socials.They got me with the scare tactics and for some reason I didn't bother to look it up until today, almost 5 days later. Everyday these guys would move the goalposts, showing the video being deleted, and then showing me how it was on another device. I really fucked up by thinking they would delete it after I paid them x amount. The first was $2000, then another $2000, then	A victim shared their experience of sextortion initiated through Bumble, which escalated to demands across various social media platforms. The victim	This case highlights the escalating nature of sextortion and the psychological impact on victims. The repeated demands for money illustrate the extortionists' strategy of continually moving the goalposts to	https://www.reddit.com/r/Sextortion/comments/1chcrop/26_m_i_lost_10000_this_week/	Communication Platforms, Financial Impact, Extortion Tactics, Victim responses and strategies
2	Subreddit/sextortion	05/05/2024	This Reddit was made by an email with a fake name / it is not from my personal email.I'm sorry it is so long, but please read the whole thing, I've done some immoral gross stuff (not illegal)Guys I really need help, and honest feedback cause I'm stressin. I'm a 20 year old man and I'm ashamed of myself. I'm disgusted of what I've done in the past till now and if anyone irl knew what I done it'll be over for me. Before I got sextorted for the first time when I was 18 I sent face nudes (pics and vids) to	A 20-year-old male shared his history of being scammed and his subsequent sextortion experience. He detailed interactions on various platforms, his distress over	It is not only victims, but also former scammers that later expirience being sextorted. It also mentions a lot of platforms for the comunication with the scammer, which could be interesing to explore over time to see a change in Forums, and maybe	https://www.reddit.com/r/Sextortion/comments/1audewt/does_background_checks_find_sites_that_might_have/	Communication Platforms, Emotional impact, Scammer Characteristics
3	Subreddit/sextortion	05/05/2024	If you're reading this, you're probably a recent victim of Sextortion and scared out of your mind.First, take a deep breath…Hopefully, this sub will be a safe place for you to share your experience and get advice from people that have already gone through what you have.This post in NOT intended to be the "be-all, end-all" source of information. I'm writing this as an intro to being sextorted. That is all.There is a really great analysis of our sub availablehere. It has all kinds of in-depth analysis of the scam, including how often leaks occur. I highly recommend you check it out.First: Let me remind you that this is Reddit and is no substitute for professional help (i.e. a mental health expert). If you are feeling suicidal, please, seek immediate help (911, or your countries equivalent, and they will be able to get you	A comprehensive post by a subreddit moderator aimed at new victims of sextortion, providing advice on steps to take and warning against recovery scams.	While not directly a victim's experience, this post is crucial in understanding the preventative measures and immediate actions recommended for sextortion victims. It emphasizes the importance of not paying the extortionists and highlights the presence of secondary scams. The reflection could explore the role of moderators and community leaders in disseminating crucial information and	https://www.reddit.com/r/Sextortion/comments/n4yorq/new_victims_please_read_first/	General information, Prevention and Awareness

Tak for i dag!

Next time: Supervision

Seminar on Thursday: Working on data sites selection

- No readings.